Westbrook City Council

~ Regular Meeting ~

Date: Monday, October 5, 2026
Time: 6:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1233173811
Packet: https://www.westbrookmaine.gov/AgendaCenter/ViewFile/Agenda/_10052026-1034

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *Summarization necessarily condenses and selects; for complete context, nuance, and anything not covered here, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

I. Land Acknowledgement, Roll Call, Pledge

Roll Call & Opening [10:59]

Discussion Summary

President Jennifer Munro called the meeting to order and noted a Committee of the Whole meeting would follow immediately after. The land acknowledgement statement was read. Roll call: Councilors McCambridge, Shaughnessy (Vice President), Chau, Faulkingham (joining remotely via Zoom), and Rairdon, plus President Munro, answered present — six of seven members. Councilor Anna Turcotte was named and marked absent. No minutes were presented for approval.

Key Decisions

✓ Quorum established — 6 of 7 members present.

Action Items

None.

II. Mayor's Message

Indigenous Peoples Day & Domestic Violence Awareness Proclamation [12:50]

Discussion Summary

Mayor David Morse spoke to the significance of Indigenous Peoples Day (observed Mon., Oct. 12) in Westbrook, tied to the Presumpscot River and Wabanaki history, and pointed residents to the Chief Polin memorial on Conant Street. He then read a proclamation recognizing October 2026 as Domestic Violence Awareness Month; a representative from Through These Doors thanked the City and described the organization's 24-hour helpline and county-wide law-enforcement partnerships.

Key Decisions

✓ Proclamation — no vote taken.

Action Items
None.

PFAS/PFOS Testing Results — Three City Athletic Fields [18:48]

Discussion Summary
City Project Manager Robyn Saunders, Credere Associates (environmental consultants), a UConn Technical Assistance to Brownfields representative, and Dave Van Sleck (senior counsel, Preti Flaherty, former director of EPA's national Superfund Enforcement Program) presented results of an ~18-month investigation into possible 1980s wastewater-sludge "land spreading" at Cornelia Warren Field, Fraser Field, and the field behind the high school/vocational center — flagged by Maine DEP in 2025 as unknown-history ("Tier 4") sites. Because the City itself signed the original land-application permits, it couldn't use its own Brownfields grant and instead used a Greater Portland Council of Governments (GPCOG) grant funded by the U.S. EPA.

Credere tested both surface soil (statistically-composited samples) and deeper core samples at each site. **All results came back below Maine DEP's Remedial Action Guidelines**, broadly consistent with ambient background PFAS levels rather than a point-source release; the high school site (where testing was limited to the existing baseball fields, since the historically permitted area is now under the vocational building/parking lot) came back even lower, and subsurface samples were lower than surface samples at every site. Maine DEP's own letter, included in the packet, states the fields "may continue to be used as recreational and athletic fields" and "pose a minimal risk as such." Formal Phase II assessment reports are still in draft pending EPA/Maine DEP review, expected finalized around early November; no material change is anticipated. A public webpage, FAQ, and press release were set to publish the next day.

Key Decisions
✓ Informational presentation — no vote taken.

Action Items
None.

> *"The news is good… The levels of PFAS compounds found are incredibly low, well below DEP guidelines for action, and consistent with background levels of PFAS found in both urban and rural environments."*

— Dave Van Sleck, senior counsel, Preti Flaherty [20:01]

Councilor Rairdon thanked the team for testing both surface and subsurface soil rather than one pass, and asked what recourse exists for residents on private property with similar historical concerns; staff and Credere pointed to Maine DEP's public PFAS database/testing program and noted the City's own Brownfields Assessment Program could support a private redevelopment project the same way.

III–V. Clerk Update, Council Messages, Student Representative

Absentee Voting, Council Messages & Student Council Representative [50:21]

Discussion Summary
City Clerk Ellis Ledoux announced Oct. 5 was the first day of in-person absentee voting for the Nov. 3 election at City Hall, with extended hours Wed. Oct. 21 and Oct. 28 (until 7 PM) and Sat. Oct. 17 (8 AM–noon); the deadline to vote absentee without a special circumstance is Oct. 29.

Councilor Rairdon spoke on Domestic Violence Awareness Month and Westbrook Strong, a family fund he and his family created that has donated to Through These Doors and two other organizations for three to four years running.

On the student council representative program: low interest last spring led to a pause; applications are being solicited again for 2026–2027 and will be reviewed with council leadership shortly.

Key Decisions

✓ Informational — no vote taken.

Action Items

None.

VII. Orders of the Day (Second & Final Reading)

Order 2026-106 — Portable Traffic Signals — Public Services [54:44]

Found on page 9 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Operations Manager Doug Eaton returned with cost-justification data requested at the prior meeting on the $64,891.31 purchase of two Vermac portable traffic signals: ~15-year municipal life expectancy, 1–2 year component/unit warranty, and an estimated ~$15,000/year (≈$88,000 over a conservative 10-year life) in flagger-wage savings.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved by unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

VIII. New Business

Resolve 2026-17 — Confirming Bruno Inácio as Finance Director & Municipal Treasurer [01:00:19]

Found on page 13 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Confirms the Mayor's appointment of Bruno Inácio as Finance Director and Municipal Treasurer (Code of Ordinances §68-16), effective September 28, 2026. Administrator Holmes introduced his background: 20+ years in public/private finance and operations leadership, most recently Director of Finance and Administrative Services for the Maine Secretary of State (overseeing a $70M+ budget), prior Director of Public Services for the Maine Bureau of Motor Vehicles, and ~8 years at UNUM in corporate strategy/operations roles. Inácio introduced himself briefly to the Council.

Key Decisions

✓ Confirmed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

IX. Orders of the Day (One Reading Required)

Order 2026-107 — Annual General Assistance Ordinance & FY 2026–27 Maximums

[01:03:46]

Found on page 15 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Required a public hearing, held with no speakers. Sets annual General Assistance benefit maximums (Appendices A, B, D, E, F, G, H) for Oct. 1, 2026 – Sept. 30, 2027, per Maine Department of Health and Human Services requirements. Appendix C (housing maximums) was included for information only, not adopted, preserving the City's negotiating leverage with landlords.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved by unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-108 — Unappropriated Funds Report — Q4 FY2026 [01:07:11]

Found on page 115 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Accepts the fourth-quarter report of departmental donations/expenditures under $5,000, per Order 2021-121's quarterly reporting requirement. Councilor Chau thanked donors to the police, fire, library, public services, and community services departments.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved by unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

X. Orders of the Day (First Reading — Two Readings Required)

All six orders below passed first reading unanimously, 6–0, with little or no discussion beyond staff's brief context. They returned for second/final reading as a consent block at the Oct 19, 2026 Special Meeting — see that meeting's summary for the final vote.

Order 2026-109 — Fire Department Pickup Truck — Bid Award [01:09:16]

Found on page 119 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

$71,476 bid award to Casco Bay Ford (Yarmouth, Maine) for a 2027 Ford F-350 replacing Unit 7, a medium-duty pickup out of service ~2 years, used to haul departmental trailers and forestry equipment. Two bids were received; Casco Bay Ford was lowest.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed first reading, unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-110 — Federal Asset Forfeiture Funds [01:11:30]

Found on page 128 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

$5,433.05 credited to the Police Department following its participation, via an officer assigned to the FBI's Safe Streets Task Force, in a multi-agency methamphetamine-dealer investigation.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed first reading, unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-111 — Mill Brook Preserve Improvements — Presumpscot Regional Land Trust [01:13:21]

Found on page 131 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

$50,000 to the Presumpscot Regional Land Trust (PRLT) for trail and signage improvements, recommended by the Recreation & Conservation Commission, responding to growing visitor interest in the preserve's alewife run.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed first reading, unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-112 — Rock Row Eastern Connector Trail — Portland Trails [01:15:34]

Found on page 138 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

$10,000 to Portland Trails toward the Rock Row Eastern Connector Trail, building on Maine Turnpike Authority funding already secured, to connect the Rock Row campus/Jewell Falls to Portland's Stroudwater Trail Network.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed first reading, unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-113 — Credere Associates Task Order No. 11 — Riverwalk North [01:17:39]

Found on page 142 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Authorizes Task Order No. 11 with Credere Associates (not to exceed $40,970) for geotechnical modeling and construction-cost estimating on the Riverwalk North project, funded by an FY24 U.S. EPA Brownfields Cleanup Grant.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed first reading, unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-114 — Landslide Vulnerability Assessment — Vendor List Amendment

[01:19:55]

Found on page 148 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Amends the landslide-vulnerability-assessment project's vendor list and funding: $22,000 (University of Maine College of Engineering, geotechnical work), $27,960 (Credere Associates, federal grant administration/contractor management), $60,999 (Camoin Associates, policy development/economic impact assessment), $37,175 (Soil Metrics, subsurface investigation), and $5,000/$10,000 stipends (Soil Metrics/Apex Companies) for technical advisory panel participation. Funded by congressionally directed spending (Sens. King and Collins) plus Maine DOT Infrastructure Adaptation Fund matching funds; project completion targeted September 2027.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed first reading, unanimous roll call, 6–0.

Action Items

None.

XI–XV. Public Comment, Referrals, Committee Reports, Executive Session

Closing Business & Adjournment [01:22:50]

Discussion Summary

No public comment, referrals, committee reports, or executive session.

Key Decisions

✓ Adjourned by unanimous roll call, 6–0. The Committee of the Whole meeting followed approximately five minutes later (see that meeting's separate summary).

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was downloaded with Downie 4 and transcribed with speaker diarization using MacWhisper. Claude (Anthropic's AI) cross-checked names against the official city council roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the presiding officer) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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